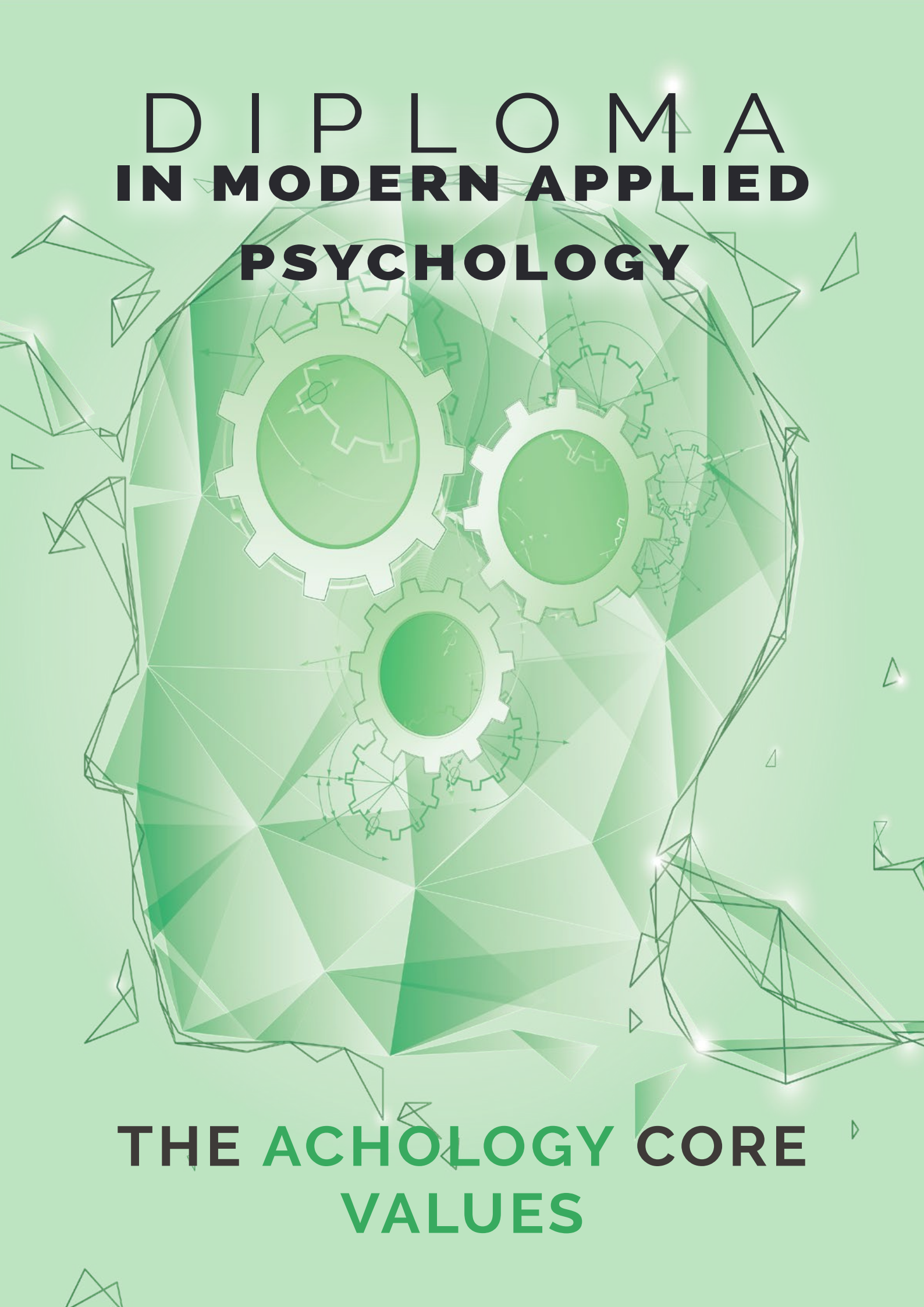


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a vibrant green with a complex, abstract geometric pattern. It features a large, central, multi-faceted shape resembling a stylized head or a brain, composed of various shades of green triangles and polygons. Overlaid on this are several interlocking gears of different sizes, some in white and some in green, with arrows indicating a clockwise flow. The overall aesthetic is modern and technological, with sharp lines and a sense of dynamic movement.

THE ACHOLOGY CORE VALUES

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You might be asking: why personal core values are so important? Values are a part of us: they highlight what we stand for. They represent our unique, individual essence and act as the primary driving force behind our actions and behaviours that provides us with a set of 'rules' to live by, alongside a personal code of conduct.

Values guide our decisions. Whilst our values in life are constant, our priorities are always changing; therefore meaning how we prioritise our values are susceptible to change. Much like the core values of a company, our personal core values guide our behaviour and choices in life which ultimately go on to affect other people.

The decisions we make as Modern Applied Psychologists will have a significant impact on other people who are entrusting us to help them. Having a firm understanding of your core values helps you become a quicker, more focused and effective decision-maker, with the confidence and clear direction a client needs to inspire them to manage the big and small decisions they need to make in life. Without a solid understanding of what our core values are, we will find ourselves feeling lost, disorganised and ungrounded in every aspect of our lives.

Value plays an important role in one's mental well being: when we abide by our core values we feel authentic and principled, but when we lose sight of them or act against them, we become numb with guilt and shame and feel devoured by a sense of utter meaninglessness. Values enhance the self, and when we love, connect, grow, appreciate and protect, we become more valuable.

Although your personal core values may not exactly match anyone else's, understanding what they are will still help you determine your surrounding culture and make better-informed decisions. Some people will consciously (or unconsciously) use their personal core values to choose friendships, relationships and business partnerships. Our core values also help us wisely manage our personal resources such as time and money. Simply put, core values serve us as effective decision-making guidelines that help us to remain congruent, consistent and balanced in the eyes of other people. No one trusts anyone who presents themselves as being inconsistent with their pledged values.

Our values should (ideally) determine our priorities in life. Life is usually going pretty well, and we feel content and satisfied when the decisions we make match our values and priorities. However, when our decisions don't align with our values, that's when we start feeling like something's 'wrong' and this can lead to dissatisfaction, frustration and in some instances, even bitterness or resentment. To avoid this, we must make a real effort to identify what our values actually are.

HOW DO I IDENTIFY MY VALUES?

Our values are like a compass that points us to our 'true north'. This workbook provides great exercises that will help you to identify your personal values clearly.

Exercise 1: Can you reflect back on a moment where you felt happy, fulfilled and proud of yourself? Take some time to describe this moment in detail. Identify what elements of this situation, in particular, led to these feelings of happiness and pride.



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1. What were you doing?
2. Were you with other people, and if so who?
3. What other factors contributed to your happiness?

In the same way that we feel happy and fulfilled when we're living out our values, we can also experience feelings of regret, sadness, and emptiness when we are not living out our values.

Exercise 2: Take a few moments to remember a time when you felt incredibly regretful. Describe the details of this situation/memory: what was it specifically that led to these feelings of regret?

Feeling frustrated or unfulfilled can often be a sign that our values might be being quashed, perhaps by parts of ourselves, by external situations or other people.

Exercise 3: Identify a time when you felt frustrated, unfulfilled, empty or annoyed? Make a note of the particular elements of this situation that led to these feelings of frustration, unfulfillment and emptiness.



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There are certain activities that we can find ourselves doing that engross us and cause us to get into the flow. These are usually activities that are challenging and rewarding, and when we're doing them we often lose track of time.

Exercise 4: Make a list of any activities where you experience this flow? What is it specifically about these activities that you enjoy so much?

We cannot grow in life without being evoked by inspiration: creativity, self-esteem, perceived competence and optimism are all consequences of inspiration. From a very early age we adopt this idea of wishing to be like someone in order to become someone; whilst in our earliest years our concept of inspiration tended to revolve around what you wanted to be in terms of career, as we get older, we take inspiration from people who we admire the traits of. There are certain people that we come across in life who we find inspiring and embody qualities or live lives that we aspire to.

Exercise 5: Who are your role models and what qualities about these individuals do you admire?

Exercise 6: Everyone has something to offer to the world. Take the time on this page to acknowledge what you have to give to those around you, and what makes you of value.

1. What are my natural gifts and qualities?

2. When do other people usually turn to you for help?

3. What qualities and gifts do you identify in yourself that you believe others may find of value?



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Exercise 7: Determine your most important values based on your experiences of inner peace. Consider why each experience is so memorable and important?

Use the list of common personal values on the next page to help you get started – aim for approximately 10 top values. As you work through this exercise, you may find that some of these values combine naturally: for example, if you value generosity, philanthropy, and community, you could say that serving others is one of your top values.

EXAMPLES OF CORE VALUES

Accountability
Accuracy
Achievement
Adventurousness
Authenticity
Ambition
Assertiveness
Balance
Belonging
Boldness
Calmness
Carefulness
Challenge
Clear-mindedness
Commitment
Community
Compassion
Connection
Consistency
Contentment
Self Improvement
Contribution
Certainty
Creativity
Decisiveness
Dependability
Determination
Devoutness
Diligence
Discipline
Discretion
Practicality

Purpose
Professionalism
Progress
Reliability
Resourcefulness
Restraint
Relationships
Security
Self Actualisation
Self-control
Significance
Selflessness
Self-Worth
Spontaneity
Stability
Sharing
Teamwork
Temperance
Truth
Thoroughness
Timeliness
Tolerance
Traditionalism
Trustworthiness
Truth-seeking
Understanding
Uniqueness
Unity
Vision
Vitality
Authenticity
Effectiveness

Efficiency
Empathy
Enthusiasm
Equality
Excellence
Excitement
Exploration
Expressiveness
Fairness
Faith
Freedom
Generosity
Goodness
Giving
Growth
Hard Work
Giving
Honesty
Hope
Humility
Independence
Ingenuity
Identity
Increase
Justice
Leadership
Legacy
Love
Loyalty
Obedience
Openness

Note: Although this list of potential values is thorough, it is not necessarily complete. Please feel free to



THE ACHOLOGY CORE VALUES

add to the list if required.

Exercise 8: Now take a few moments to prioritise your 'top' values. This step is usually the most challenging as you'll have to look deep within yourself. However, it's also the most important step, because, when you're faced with a decision, you may have to choose between solutions that will satisfy different values.

This is when it's crucial to know which value is more important to you. Without worrying about the order, make a list of your top 10 values. Look at the first two values on the list and ask yourself, 'If I could only satisfy one of these, which one would I choose?'

Work your way through the list, comparing each value with each of the other values until you've got your list in the correct order for you.

Exercise 9: Reaffirming your values - Take a few moments to check your top-priority values and make sure they fit with your life and your vision for yourself.

1. Do the values you've chosen make you feel good about yourself?
2. Are you proud of your top three values?
3. Would you be comfortable telling people you respect your values?
4. Do these values represent things you would support, even if your choice weren't popular and put you in the minority?
5. What are your goals in life? How do your values relate to the goals you have in life?

When you take into consideration your values in decision making, you can be certain to keep a sense of integrity and what you know is right, while being able to approach decisions with confidence and clarity.



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You'll also know that what you're currently doing is motivated by the progress that you want to make in life. It's not always easy to make value-based choices, but it will more than likely make life much easier in the long run.

Exercise 10: How do you hold yourself accountable?

Write down your preferred feedback system which you will use to hold yourself accountable for living according to your values.

Write down all the ways you can think of that you can break your values. Have you ever broken your values before or are you prone to breaking them a certain way?

Write down your support system (i.e. the people you want to hold you accountable for living according to your values). How are you going to ask them to keep you accountable?

KEY POINTS:

- Identifying and taking the time to understand your values is an important and challenging exercise. Your personal values are central to who you are – and who you want to become.
- By becoming more aware of these important factors in your life, you can use them as a guide to making the best choice in any situation. Some of life's decisions are really about determining what you value most.
- When many options seem reasonable, it can be comforting and helpful to rely on your core values and use them as a strong guiding force to point you in the right direction.

